

to various different things, I'd like you to try practising a little bit of foresight. When we create our budgets, we're often in a very motivated, determined frame of mind, which is obviously great – but I'd like you to consider how easy or hard your budget might be to engage with when you have a lot on your plate, or when you're going through a period of high anxiety or low mood. Make sure that you're building something with some sway, and with compassion for your future self.

If you're not sure where to start with the practical stuff, you can download a simple, easy-to-adapt budget template for Excel and Google Sheets at www.thefwforum.com/resources/.

Checking your bank balance regularly

One of the challenges to financial wellbeing that arises again and again is the tendency to bury our heads in the sand when it comes to money. I did this for years, and while the immediate threat of what was going on with my finances was mostly neutralized, the anxiety continued to bubble away under the surface as the actual material problems grew in the dark. I was in the habit of ignoring things until they got too big and conspicuous to bypass, and then I would deal with them as quickly and superficially as I could before returning my head resolutely to the sand. A 2018 study by NS&I about money and wellbeing suggests that this isn't particularly uncommon – in fact, almost three quarters (73%) who said that